

Hiruy Kassa

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EDUCATION

University of St. Thomas

B.S. in Computer Science, GPA: 3.65/4.0, Dean's List

May 2027

St. Paul, MN

EXPERIENCE

IT Support & Technician

University of St. Thomas

Mar. 2026 – Present

St. Paul & Minneapolis, MN

- Resolved 50+ tickets/week at a 90%+ same-day rate across hardware, software, and account issues for a campus of 11,000+ students, faculty, and staff.
- Deployed 30+ workstations/week during peak summer demand through OS imaging, software configuration, and Active Directory domain joins across a multi-campus environment.

Research Assistant, Human-AI Interaction

University of St. Thomas (Advisor: Dr. Michael Hoefer)

Sep. 2026 – Present

St. Paul, MN

- Co-designing a technology-probe study on whether reviewing one's own AI chat logs prompts reflection on values and virtues, as a core member of a multi-year HCI project.
- Developing the reflection flow and annotation scheme that maps AI conversations to cardinal, intellectual, and theological virtues, grounded in a multi-level reflection model for personal informatics.
- Defining chat-summary criteria (user intent, outcome, AI-performed tasks, anthropomorphism) for a 20–30 participant think-aloud study informing a planned HCI publication.

Solutions Architect Intern

FZ Contracting

Jan. 2026 – Mar. 2026

Minneapolis, MN

- Designed a 6-stage agentic AI workflow to automate 5 manual processes, specified in a 22-requirement PRD.
- Mapped Google Calendar, Maps, and Twilio SMS integrations, defining data flow and error handling per stage.

PROJECTS

Ask the Early Church | React, Flask, Python, SQLite, Voyage AI, AWS

Jun. 2026 – Aug. 2026

- Built a hybrid search engine serving 2,000+ monthly users across 52,000+ passages, combining vector and keyword (BM25) search with reciprocal rank fusion.
- Kept the site running during API outages with fallbacks across LLM providers (Gemini, Groq, local) and a budget cap.
- Reduced memory use about 3x by storing embeddings in float16, keeping the full corpus in RAM.
- Migrated from Render and Netlify to AWS (App Runner, S3, CloudFront), debugging 3 deploy failures via container logs.
- Restored missing security headers after the migration by writing a CloudFront response headers policy.

AI Examen: AI-Use Reflection Platform | TypeScript, React, Recharts

Sep. 2026 – Present

- Architecting the system and front end of an AI-reflection web app: a TypeScript parser that normalizes ChatGPT/Claude chat exports and a React interface for virtue annotation and usage visualizations.
- Defining a unified conversation schema and API contract with a co-researcher's database layer, keeping raw chat logs on the participant's device until consent to meet IRB privacy requirements.

LEADERSHIP & AFFILIATIONS

Member

ColorStack

Nov. 2024 – Present

National

- Engage with a national community of 10,000+ CS students focused on career development and technical growth.

Captain

Club Soccer

Sep. 2024 – May 2025

St. Olaf College

- Led a 20+ player roster in matches against colleges across Minnesota, coordinating 2 weekly practices and mentoring teammates.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, Java, HTML/CSS

Frameworks & Libraries: React, Flask, Pandas, BeautifulSoup

AI / ML: RAG, vector embeddings, hybrid search (BM25 + dense), LLM evaluation

AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (App Runner, S3, CloudFront, ECR, IAM, KMS, CloudWatch), Docker, GitHub Actions, Linux